The Garden Table - Sustainability Report 2025

This report summarizes how the restaurant reduced its environmental impact in 2025.

Local and seasonal sourcing

In 2025, 70% of our fresh produce came from farms within 150 kilometers of Downtown. Our main suppliers are Hollow Creek Farm (vegetables and herbs), Two Rivers Dairy (milk, butter and cheese) and Cedar Point Fisheries, which supplies our salmon from certified sustainable fisheries. The menu changes with the seasons so that the kitchen can buy what local farms harvest.

Food waste

- All kitchen food scraps are composted through the city composting program.
- Unsold food that is still safe to eat is donated every night to Second Harvest Kitchen, a local community kitchen.
- The kitchen measures food waste every week. In 2025 food waste per guest fell by 22% compared with 2024.

Energy and water

- Since January 2025 both locations use 100% renewable electricity through the city green energy tariff.
- The Downtown kitchen replaced its gas fryers with electric induction equipment in 2025.
- Low-flow taps and a water-efficient dishwasher reduced water use by 15%.
- Filtered still water is served for free in reusable glass bottles instead of selling bottled still water.

Packaging

- Takeaway packaging is compostable.
- The reusable container program, with a $1 deposit per container, replaced about 9,000 single-use containers in 2025.
- Plastic straws are not used; paper straws are available on request.

Goals for 2026

- Reach 80% of fresh produce from within 150 kilometers.
- Open a small herb garden on the Riverside terrace.
- Cut food waste per guest by another 10%.